



PERFORMANCE AND STRATEGY

INTERVIEW WITH DR. M ANGAMUTHU, IAS,
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AUTHORITY (VPA)

Q Visakhapatnam Port Authority continues to stand tall among India's leading ports. Could you share the key performance highlights from FY2024–25, including cargo volumes, major commodities, and operational achievements?

Visakhapatnam Port Authority (VPA) recognized as the Cleanest Major Port in India and ranked 4th nationally in cargo handling and 19th globally in the CPPI rankings.

During FY2024–25, VPA handled a record 82.62 million metric tonnes (MMT) of cargo, marking its highest-ever throughput and reflecting a decadal growth of 3.78% CAGR.

The Port has 31 berths (19 port-operated, 12 PPP/O&M) and a SPM with a total capacity of 142 MTPA. Out of total traffic handled by VPA 47% cargo is handled through PPP/O&M mode, 30% of cargo being handled by port through pipelines. With higher draft levels (up to 18.10 m in the Outer Harbour), efficient turnaround times, and mechanized handling systems, VPA continues to

serve as a key gateway on India's East Coast for coal, iron ore, fertilizers, POL, and containerized cargo.

Q What is the cargo handling target for FY2025–26, and what strategic initiatives are being implemented to achieve it?

VPA has set an ambitious target of 90.0 MMT cargo throughputs for FY2025–26, aiming to reach 100 MMT within five years.

To achieve this, the Port is strengthening multimodal connectivity, mechanization, and digital efficiency. Mechanization projects are being taken up for EQ-2 to 5 and WQ-1 to 3, alongside ongoing projects at WQ6, WQ7&8, EQ6 & EQ7, to enhance berth productivity and cargo evacuation.

Further, VPA continues to pursue the Landlord Port model, attracting private participation through PPP and O&M modes. Collaborative MoUs with RINL and NMDC for assured cargo volumes, as well as focused partnerships with key industries.

